

Hydrotherapy Pools Near You – UK Guide

Find NHS and community hydrotherapy pools across the UK. Learn the benefits of warm water therapy for arthritis and how to get a referral from your GP.

By **Living With Arthritis Editorial Team** · Reviewed by **Clinical Advisory Panel** (HCPC-registered physiotherapy & rheumatology nursing input) · 2026-02-25 · livingwitharthritis.org.uk

Hydrotherapy — exercising in warm water (33-36°C) — is one of the most effective treatments for arthritis. The warmth relaxes muscles and eases pain, while the water's buoyancy supports your body weight, reducing stress on joints.

Benefits of Hydrotherapy for Arthritis

- Pain relief — warm water raises body temperature, increasing blood flow and releasing endorphins
 - Reduced stiffness — heat and gentle movement improve joint mobility
 - Muscle strengthening — water provides natural resistance without joint impact
 - Improved balance — water supports you, making balance exercises safer
 - Psychological benefits — warm water promotes relaxation and stress relief
-

How to Access Hydrotherapy in the UK



Openly licensed image via Openverse

NHS Hydrotherapy

Many NHS trusts offer hydrotherapy through physiotherapy departments:

- Ask your GP for a referral to NHS physiotherapy
- Request hydrotherapy specifically — not all physiotherapy includes pool sessions
- Typical NHS course: 6-8 sessions with a physiotherapist in the pool
- Waiting times vary by area — typically 6-12 weeks

Community Hydrotherapy

- Many leisure centres offer warm water sessions or arthritis-friendly swim times
 - Search "warm water swimming" or "hydrotherapy" on your local council website
 - Some centres offer discounted rates for people with health conditions
-

What to Expect

- Water temperature is typically 33-36°C (warmer than a normal pool at 27-29°C)
 - Sessions usually last 30-45 minutes
 - A physiotherapist guides you through exercises in the water
 - You don't need to be a swimmer — exercises are done standing or with floats
 - Wear a comfortable swimsuit; the pool has handrails and steps for easy access
-

Finding Pools Near You



Openly licensed image via Openverse

- Ask your GP or physiotherapist for local recommendations
- Check your local council's leisure services website

- Contact local arthritis support groups — they often know the best facilities
- Some private physiotherapy clinics have on-site hydrotherapy pools

Hydrotherapy may not be suitable if you have certain heart conditions, skin infections, or open wounds. Discuss with your GP before starting.

Q&A

Question: What is the key thing to know about hydrotherapy pools near you – uk guide?

Short answer: Hydrotherapy is exercising in warm water, typically between 33-36°C, to relieve arthritis symptoms. The warmth relaxes muscles and eases pain, while water's buoyancy supports body weight, reducing joint stress. Benefits include pain relief, reduced stiffness, muscle strengthening, and improved balance. Access hydrotherapy through NHS physiotherapy referrals or community leisure centres offering warm water sessions.

Question: When should I seek professional advice?

Short answer: If symptoms persist or worsen, pain is severe and unresponsive to usual relief, or you develop new symptoms, contact your GP, physiotherapist or rheumatology team promptly.

Question: Where can I get free arthritis support in the UK?

Short answer: Versus Arthritis: 0800 5200 520. NRAS: 0800 298 7650. Free tools and guides at livingwitharthritis.org.uk.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis UK · livingwitharthritis.org.uk